MARYLEBONE ROSTER · LINKS DESIGNER · THE SHORTLIST AT A GLANCE

The shortlist at a glance

Balanced V6, Level Crossing and Middle Ground, shortlisted from 18 designs, beside today's link

The new CEA link from January 2027 · prepared 9 November 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

Whichever is chosen

the same on all three, against today

✓ BETTER THAN TODAY, COVER WEEKS ASIDE

- **9 of 9** December timetable staffing rules met — today 4 of 9
- **8h 10m** longest weekday closing shift — today 8h 40m
- **5** days in a row at most — today 7
- **3** on the floor at all times — today 2
- **0** avoidable fatigue warnings — today 4
- **14h 20m** rest between shifts, at least — today 12h 30m

= AS TODAY

- **30** days off in a row for 14 days' leave at best, as today
- **14** days' leave for four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday, as today
- **35h** week, 218.6 contracted days a year — today 219.0

▲ WORSE THAN TODAY

- **28** Saturdays at work, a year — today 26
- **94** finishes at 22:00 or later, a year — today 78
- **42** finishes at 23:00 or later, a year — today 39

Where they differ

✓ better than today ▲ worse than today no mark: as today, or a matter of taste **Bold** the best of the three, ties included

Measure	Today 20 lines	Balanced V6 26 lines	Level Crossing 26 lines	Middle Ground 26 lines
Leave and time off				
Days off in a row for 14 days' leave, at worst	19	19	19	✓ **20**
Sunday overtime duties lost in the 30 days off	2	✓ **1**	2	2
Full weekends off, a year	10	✓ 12	✓ **14**	✓ **14**
Breaks of three or four rest days, a year	13	▲ **6**	▲ 2	▲ 4
Single rest days, a year	10	▲ 22	**10**	▲ 12
Your shifts				
Weeks a year on one shift time, Mon–Fri	18	▲ 14	✓ **36**	✓ **36**
Average change of start time, week to week	4h 00m	▲ 4h 08m	✓ **1h 34m**	✓ 1h 42m
Longest run of weeks of earlies, or of lates	2, up to 3	▲ **3, up to 5**	▲ 5, up to 7	▲ 5, up to 7
New shift times to learn	none	▲ 8	▲ **6**	▲ **6**
Starts at 06:20, a year (a matter of taste)	62	50	58	48
Earlies finishing before 14:00, a year	26	▲ **20**	▲ **20**	▲ 12
Shifts over 8h 30m, Mon–Sat, a year	31	✓ 8	✓ 6	✓ **none**
Longest Saturday closing shift	9h 10m	✓ 8h 55m	✓ 8h 40m	✓ **8h 10m**
If a cover week falls badly				
Most days at work in a row	9	▲ 10	✓ **6**	✓ 7
Avoidable fatigue warnings	5	✓ 4	✓ **none**	✓ 1
Most hours in any seven days	60h 45m	✓ 58h 35m	✓ **50h 30m**	✓ 57h 00m
Trains and pay				
Fit to the trains, weekday · Sat · Sun (0 = exact)	52.0 · 65.9 · 70.2	✓ 40.0 · 17.3 · 29.2	✓ **31.4** · 17.6 · 29.2	✓ 32.7 · **9.8** · **28.6**
Your pay, working your share of Sundays	—	▲ about £200 less	▲ about £200 less	▲ about £350 less
Your pay, working no overtime at all	—	✓ about £140 more	✓ about £130 more	✓ about £90 more

Each one's edge, and its cost

Balanced V6

MB-26-V6 · 1818a1c2

- ✓ **Of the three, the shortest runs of earlies or of lates, and the most breaks of three or four rest days; five at the Saturday open.**
- ▲ The fewest weeks on one shift time, and the only ones mixing earlies and lates; the biggest change of start; the most single rest days; the fewest weekends off; the most fatigue warnings and days in a row if a cover week falls badly.

Level Crossing

LC-26-T10 · 32241e32

- ✓ **No avoidable fatigue warning or week over 55 hours in any cover-week placement tested. Of the three, the fewest days in a row however a cover week falls, the gentlest change of start, the fewest single rest days (as today) and the most 06:20 starts, for those who like them.**
- ▲ The fewest breaks of three or four rest days, 2 a year.

Middle Ground

MG-26-T8 · 20668ac9

- ✓ **Alone of the three, no shift over 8h 30m on any day, and every closing shift 8h 10m. Of the three, the closest Saturday fit.**
- ▲ The fewest earlies finishing before 14:00, 12 a year; four at the open every day; the least pay for those who work their Sundays.

How it is counted. Over 52 weeks: the 26-week links worked through twice, today's 20-week link scaled to match. **Cover weeks** have no set duties: four days, Monday to Saturday, placed later by the roster office. "Cover weeks aside" leaves them out; "up to" and "if a cover week falls badly" take their worst placing, at 8 hours a duty. **Leave** costs a day for each working day Monday to Saturday; Sunday is overtime, so a rostered Sunday inside your leave is overtime lost. More: the shortlist sheet, "What it means if you…" and each proposal sheet.

Avoidable fatigue warnings: what the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice guidance asks to be looked at, such as over 55 hours in seven days; not a pass or fail. Two that every link has are left out: starts before 07:00 and a weekly rotation. **Fit to the trains:** how closely the staff on duty follow the trains, hour by hour; 0 is exact. **Pay** is gross, at £21.49 an hour, against today. Its two rows are two different people, never added together: with no overtime, two more Saturdays at a premium; working your Sundays, fewer and shorter Sundays as well.